MODULE 33 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Practice Exam 3 of 4

Twenty new questions, weighted like the real exam, including multiple-response questions.

QUESTIONS 20 PASS MARK 15 of 20 HOLD 9 seconds

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How to use this paper

- Pause after each question and commit to an answer before the solution appears.
- Write down your letters. Multiple-response questions need every correct letter.
- Score yourself by **domain** at the end, not only in total.
- For each miss, revisit the module named on the solution slide.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The answer teaches the fact. The module teaches the discriminator you missed.

> A CodeDeploy in-place deployment to EC2 fails on most instances during the Install event. The error says a file already exists at the destination.
>
> An engineer had copied a hotfix onto the servers by hand. The team wants the new revision's files to win.

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Reinstall the CodeDeploy agent

B Set ignoreApplicationStopFailures

C Lower minimum healthy hosts

D Redeploy with the file-exists behaviour set to OVERWRITE

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Reinstall the CodeDeploy agent

The agent is working; it is refusing to overwrite by default.

B Set ignoreApplicationStopFailures

For broken stop scripts, not existing files.

C Lower minimum healthy hosts

Changes how many fail at once, not why.

D Redeploy with the file-exists behaviour set to OVERWRITE

Replaces files that the last deployment did not place.

REVISIT MODULE 6

'File already exists' after manual changes: set fileExistsBehavior to OVERWRITE.

A V2 pipeline pauses at a manual approval before production. Approvals left pending over a weekend later release stale changes.

The team wants any approval not given within four hours to fail automatically, with no code.

What should the DevOps engineer configure?

A Set the approval action's timeout to 240 minutes

B A Lambda function that rejects approvals after four hours

C A DeploymentWindow rule on the stage

D An EventBridge schedule that stops the pipeline nightly

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer configure?

A Set the approval action's timeout to 240 minutes

Approval timeouts are configurable per action, from 5 minutes to 60 days.

B A Lambda function that rejects approvals after four hours

Custom code for a setting.

C A DeploymentWindow rule on the stage

Controls when deployments may run, not approval age.

D An EventBridge schedule that stops the pipeline nightly

Blunt, and stops healthy runs too.

REVISIT MODULE 2

Approval timeout is no longer fixed at seven days. Set it on the action.

> A V2 pipeline deploys a Lambda function. Each release must receive 10% of traffic for ten minutes before taking the rest.
>
> It must roll back automatically if the function's error alarm fires during that time.

Which steps meet these requirements? (Choose TWO.)

A. Route 53 weighted records across two function URLs

B. Use the CodePipeline Lambda deploy action with a canary of 10% for 10 minutes

C. Increase reserved concurrency

D. Name the error alarm in the deploy action for automatic rollback

E. An API Gateway stage canary

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which steps meet these requirements? (Choose TWO.)

A Route 53 weighted records across two function URLs

DNS weighting is imprecise and has no alarm rollback.

B Use the CodePipeline Lambda deploy action with a canary of 10% for 10 minutes

The action shifts alias traffic in the stated shape.

C Increase reserved concurrency

Controls capacity, not traffic shifting.

D Name the error alarm in the deploy action for automatic rollback

A firing alarm returns traffic to the previous version.

E An API Gateway stage canary

Splits at the API, without automatic promotion or alarm rollback.

REVISIT MODULE 7

Canary plus alarm rollback in a pipeline: the Lambda deploy action, with both configured.

> A team's GitHub Actions workflows need larger machines and access to AWS. Today they use GitHub-hosted runners and AWS access keys stored as repository secrets.
>
> The team wants to keep its workflow files unchanged in structure, remove stored keys, and run jobs on AWS compute.

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A. Rewrite every workflow as a CodePipeline pipeline

B. Use CodeBuild-hosted GitHub Actions runners, with jobs running under the project's service role

C. Run self-managed runners on an EC2 fleet with keys in user data

D. Rotate the stored keys weekly

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Rewrite every workflow as a CodePipeline pipeline

Abandons the workflows the team wants to keep.

B Use CodeBuild-hosted GitHub Actions runners, with jobs running under the project's service role

Workflows stay; jobs run on CodeBuild compute with no stored keys.

C Run self-managed runners on an EC2 fleet with keys in user data

A fleet to run, and keys still stored.

D Rotate the stored keys weekly

Still long-lived keys, and no bigger machines.

REVISIT MODULE 3

Keep GitHub Actions, run in AWS, no stored keys: CodeBuild-hosted runners.

A platform team publishes a shared npm library to CodeArtifact. Six application pipelines depend on it.

Whenever a new library version is published, every dependent pipeline must start automatically.

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Have each pipeline poll CodeArtifact every five minutes

B Rebuild every application nightly

C An EventBridge rule on the CodeArtifact package version event, targeting the six pipelines

D Ask the platform team to message each team after publishing

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Have each pipeline poll CodeArtifact every five minutes

Polling is the legacy pattern; wasteful and delayed.

B Rebuild every application nightly

Up to a day late, and rebuilds when nothing changed.

C An EventBridge rule on the CodeArtifact package version event, targeting the six pipelines

Publishing emits an event; the rule starts every consumer.

D Ask the platform team to message each team after publishing

Manual.

REVISIT MODULE 5

Publishing a package version is an event. React to it with EventBridge.

> Instances in a stack are configured by cfn-init from AWS::CloudFormation::Init metadata. A stack update changed a configuration file in that metadata.
>
> The update succeeded, but running instances still have the old file.

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Configure cfn-hup on the instances with a hook that re-runs cfn-init when metadata changes

B Add a CreationPolicy to the instances

C Set DeletionPolicy: Retain

D Run drift detection

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Configure cfn-hup on the instances with a hook that re-runs cfn-init when metadata changes
Running instances pick up metadata changes in place.

B Add a CreationPolicy to the instances
Waits for signals at creation; does nothing for updates.

C Set DeletionPolicy: Retain
Unrelated to configuration updates.

D Run drift detection
Would not detect file contents on the instance, nor fix them.

REVISIT MODULE 9

cfn-init runs once at launch. cfn-hup applies later metadata changes.

> A company requires that no member account can leave the organisation, and that nobody in a member account can disable or disassociate GuardDuty.
>
> This must hold even for account administrators.

Which steps meet these requirements? (Choose TWO.)

A. An SCP denying organizations:LeaveOrganization

B. A permissions boundary on administrator roles

C. An AWS Config rule that reports GuardDuty status

D. An RCP on GuardDuty detectors

E. An SCP denying GuardDuty delete, disassociate and stop actions

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which steps meet these requirements? (Choose TWO.)

A An SCP denying organizations:LeaveOrganization

Blocks leaving, for everyone in member accounts.

B A permissions boundary on administrator roles

Administrators could change it, and it misses the root user.

C An AWS Config rule that reports GuardDuty status

Detects after the fact; prevents nothing.

D An RCP on GuardDuty detectors

RCPs protect resources from outsiders; here the actors are insiders.

E An SCP denying GuardDuty delete, disassociate and stop actions

Blocks disabling GuardDuty, for everyone in member accounts.

REVISIT MODULE 12

Insiders, administrators included, must be stopped: SCPs.

> A team has 400 resources created by hand over several years across VPCs, load balancers and databases.
>
> It wants them managed by CloudFormation without recreating anything, and without writing templates by hand.

What should the DevOps engineer use?

A Write templates by hand, then import the resources

B Recreate everything with CloudFormation and migrate the data

C Export an AWS Config snapshot

D The IaC generator: scan, generate a template, then import the resources into a stack

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer use?

A Write templates by hand, then import the resources

Ruled out: no hand-written templates.

B Recreate everything with CloudFormation and migrate the data

Ruled out: nothing may be recreated.

C Export an AWS Config snapshot

Describes resources; does not create a stack.

D The IaC generator: scan, generate a template, then import the resources into a stack

Templates from what exists, adopted in place.

REVISIT MODULE 9

Existing resources, no hand-written templates, no recreation: IaC generator plus import.

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> A DynamoDB table in provisioned mode with auto scaling throttles during sudden flash sales, because scaling reacts too slowly.
>
> Traffic is unpredictable, and the team wants no throttling and no capacity planning.

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Raise the auto scaling target utilisation

B Add a DAX cluster

C Switch the table to on-demand capacity mode

D Create a global table

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Raise the auto scaling target utilisation
Leaves less headroom: more throttling.

B Add a DAX cluster
Helps reads; flash-sale writes still throttle.

C Switch the table to on-demand capacity mode
Serves sudden spikes with no capacity to plan.

D Create a global table
Multi-Region, not burst capacity.

REVISIT MODULE 15

Unpredictable spikes, no capacity planning: on-demand.

> Objects written to an S3 bucket must appear in a second Region within 15 minutes, with a service commitment and metrics to prove it.
>
> Existing objects are already replicated.

What should the DevOps engineer configure?

A Batch Replication every night

B Cross-Region Replication with Replication Time Control

C Cross-Region Replication without Replication Time Control

D AWS DataSync on a 15-minute schedule

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer configure?

A Batch Replication every night

Up to a day late.

B Cross-Region Replication with Replication Time Control

99.99% within 15 minutes, with replication metrics and events.

C Cross-Region Replication without Replication Time Control

Usually fast, but no commitment or metrics.

D AWS DataSync on a 15-minute schedule

Scheduled copying, with no replication commitment.

REVISIT MODULE 14

'Within 15 minutes, with a commitment and metrics': Replication Time Control.

> An application behind AWS Global Accelerator is moving from us-east-1 to eu-west-1. Both Regions now run healthy endpoint groups.
>
> The team wants to move traffic gradually, 10% at a time, reversible instantly, without DNS caching delays.

What should the DevOps engineer adjust?

A The traffic dial on the us-east-1 endpoint group

B Route 53 weighted records

C A CloudFront origin group

D Cross-zone load balancing

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer adjust?

A The traffic dial on the us-east-1 endpoint group

Turning it down sends that share to the other group, instantly, with no DNS involved.

B Route 53 weighted records

DNS caching delays the shift; the requirement rules it out.

C A CloudFront origin group

Fails over on errors; does not shift percentages.

D Cross-zone load balancing

Within one Region only.

REVISIT MODULE 14

Gradual Regional shift, instant, no DNS: Global Accelerator traffic dials.

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> A legacy daemon on 200 EC2 instances sometimes exits silently. The instances stay healthy, so nobody notices for hours.
>
> The team wants an alarm on any instance where the daemon's process is not running.

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A An alarm on the instances' CPU utilisation

B An alarm on EC2 status checks

C The CloudWatch agent's procstat plugin for the process, with an alarm when its process count drops to zero

D X-Ray tracing

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A An alarm on the instances' CPU utilisation

A stopped daemon may barely change CPU.

B An alarm on EC2 status checks

The instances stay healthy; status checks pass.

C The CloudWatch agent's procstat plugin for the process, with an alarm when its process count drops to zero

Measures the process itself.

D X-Ray tracing

The daemon serves no traced requests.

REVISIT MODULE 17

Watch the thing that fails: a per-process metric from the agent.

A company uses a third-party monitoring platform. It wants CloudWatch metrics for several namespaces delivered there continuously, within minutes.

It wants no custom code and no API polling.

What should the DevOps engineer set up?

A A scheduled Lambda function calling GetMetricData

B A log subscription filter to the partner

C Daily metric exports to S3

D A CloudWatch metric stream through Firehose to the partner, filtered by namespace

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer set up?

A. A scheduled Lambda function calling GetMetricData
Custom polling code.

B. A log subscription filter to the partner
Subscriptions carry logs, not metrics.

C. Daily metric exports to S3
Not continuous, and there is no such export.

D. A CloudWatch metric stream through Firehose to the partner, filtered by namespace
Continuous delivery of chosen metrics, no code.

REVISIT MODULE 17

Metrics out, continuously, no polling: metric streams. Logs use subscription filters.

> Customers report slow page loads in some countries, but server-side metrics look normal. The company also wants to know immediately if the sign-up page breaks, even at night with no traffic.
>
> It wants AWS-native tools and the least effort.

Which steps meet these requirements? (Choose TWO.)

A CloudWatch RUM on the web application

B VPC Flow Logs

C A CloudWatch Synthetics canary scripting the sign-up flow

D Contributor Insights on the server logs

E X-Ray tracing on the backend

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which steps meet these requirements? (Choose TWO.)

A CloudWatch RUM on the web application

Captures real users' page load times from their browsers.

B VPC Flow Logs

Network flows, not page experience.

C A CloudWatch Synthetics canary scripting the sign-up flow

Tests the page on a schedule, even with no traffic.

D Contributor Insights on the server logs

Server-side data, which already looks normal.

E X-Ray tracing on the backend

Backend only; the slowness is on the client side.

REVISIT MODULE 18

Real users' experience: RUM. Breakage with no traffic: a synthetic canary.

A stack update failed, and the automatic rollback also failed, leaving the stack in UPDATE_ROLLBACK_FAILED.

The rollback cannot restore a queue that someone deleted by hand. Every other resource is fine.

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Delete the stack and create it again

B Continue the update rollback, skipping the deleted queue

C Run drift detection

D Recreate the queue by hand with a new name

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Delete the stack and create it again

Destroys every healthy resource to fix one.

B Continue the update rollback, skipping the deleted queue

Completes the rollback; the stack becomes usable again.

C Run drift detection

Reports the difference; does not unstick the stack.

D Recreate the queue by hand with a new name

The stack still cannot roll back.

REVISIT MODULE 23

UPDATE_ROLLBACK_FAILED: fix the cause, or skip the resource, and continue the rollback.

> A DynamoDB table's stream carries every order change. Only changes where status becomes FAILED matter; each needs customer details added before starting a Step Functions workflow.
>
> The team wants the least custom code.

What should the DevOps engineer use?

A. A Lambda function that reads the stream, filters, looks up customers and starts the workflow

B. An EventBridge rule on DynamoDB item changes

C. Kinesis Data Firehose to S3, then a nightly job

D. EventBridge Pipes: stream source, a filter on FAILED, enrichment, and a Step Functions target

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

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What should the DevOps engineer use?

A A Lambda function that reads the stream, filters, looks up customers and starts the workflow
Works, but all of it is custom code.

B An EventBridge rule on DynamoDB item changes
Item changes are not published to the default bus.

C Kinesis Data Firehose to S3, then a nightly job
Delayed, and still custom.

D EventBridge Pipes: stream source, a filter on FAILED, enrichment, and a Step Functions target
Point to point with built-in filtering and enrichment.

REVISIT MODULE 21

One source, filter, enrich, one target: Pipes. Only the enrichment needs code.

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> EC2 instances in private subnets with no internet access must read a Secrets Manager secret.
>
> The secret must also be unreadable from anywhere except through that VPC's private path.

Which steps meet these requirements? (Choose TWO.)

A Add a NAT gateway

B A Secrets Manager interface endpoint with private DNS

C Assign public IP addresses to the instances

D A gateway endpoint for Secrets Manager

E A secret resource policy denying access unless aws:SourceVpce is that endpoint

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

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Which steps meet these requirements? (Choose TWO.)

A Add a NAT gateway

Gives internet access, which the design rules out.

B A Secrets Manager interface endpoint with private DNS

A private path from the subnets to Secrets Manager.

C Assign public IP addresses to the instances

Exposes the instances; wrong direction entirely.

D A gateway endpoint for Secrets Manager

Gateway endpoints exist only for S3 and DynamoDB.

E A secret resource policy denying access unless aws:SourceVpce is that endpoint

Locks the secret to the private path.

REVISIT MODULE 26

A private path, and a policy that insists on it: interface endpoint plus aws:SourceVpce.

> The security team's own vulnerability scanner runs weekly from known addresses. GuardDuty raises dozens of expected findings each time.
>
> The team wants those findings archived automatically, while every other finding stays visible.

What should the DevOps engineer configure?

A. A GuardDuty suppression rule matching the scanner's findings

B. Disable GuardDuty during the scan

C. Lower every finding's severity with an EventBridge rule

D. Delete the findings by hand after each scan

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

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What should the DevOps engineer configure?

A. A GuardDuty suppression rule matching the scanner's findings
Archives only the expected findings, automatically.

B. Disable GuardDuty during the scan
Blinds the company to real threats during that window.

C. Lower every finding's severity with an EventBridge rule
Affects all findings, and is not how severity works.

D. Delete the findings by hand after each scan
Manual, every week.

REVISIT MODULE 27

Expected noise from a known source: a suppression rule, never disabling detection.

A company wants Security Hub CSPM's foundational best practices standard enabled in all 80 accounts and every Region, with three controls turned off everywhere because they do not apply.

New accounts must receive the same configuration automatically.

What should the DevOps engineer use?

A Configure each account and Region by hand

B A StackSet deploying Security Hub settings

C A central configuration policy from the Security Hub delegated administrator

D An AWS Config conformance pack

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer use?

A Configure each account and Region by hand

Hundreds of settings, and new accounts are missed.

B A StackSet deploying Security Hub settings

Reinvents the service's organisation feature.

C A central configuration policy from the Security Hub delegated administrator

Standards and controls set once, applied to all accounts, Regions and new accounts.

D An AWS Config conformance pack

Deploys Config rules, not Security Hub standards and controls.

REVISIT MODULE 27

Standards and controls across the organisation: Security Hub central configuration.

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> Several load balancers use certificates imported into ACM from a third-party authority. One expired last month and caused an outage.
>
> The team wants warnings well before any imported certificate expires, with no custom code.

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Rely on ACM's automatic renewal

B Route ACM's approaching-expiration events, or the acm-certificate-expiration-check Config rule, to an SNS topic

C A monthly review of the certificate list

D CloudTrail event history

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should the DevOps engineer do?

A Rely on ACM's automatic renewal

ACM never renews imported certificates: the cause of the outage.

B Route ACM's approaching-expiration events, or the acm-certificate-expiration-check Config rule, to an SNS topic

Native warnings in advance, for imported certificates too.

C A monthly review of the certificate list

Manual, and it missed one already.

D CloudTrail event history

Records API calls, not upcoming expiry.

REVISIT MODULE 25

Imported certificates never auto-renew. Watch their expiry with native events or a Config rule.

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Answer key

- **Answer key:** 1 D, 2 A, 3 BD, 4 B, 5 C, 6 A, 7 AE, 8 D, 9 C, 10 B
- **Answer key:** 11 A, 12 C, 13 D, 14 AC, 15 B, 16 D, 17 BE, 18 A, 19 C, 20 B
- Multiple response (3, 7, 14, 17) score only if every letter is right.
- 15 or more: on track. 13 or 14: close. 12 or fewer: revisit weak domains first.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Each solution slide named the module to revisit. Use it for every miss.

Scoring by domain

DOMAIN	QUESTIONS	MODULES TO REVISIT
D1 SDLC Automation	1, 2, 3, 4, 5	2, 3, 5, 6, 7
D2 Configuration Management and IaC	6, 7, 8	9, 12
D3 Resilient Cloud Solutions	9, 10, 11	14, 15
D4 Monitoring and Logging	12, 13, 14	17, 18
D5 Incident and Event Response	15, 16	21, 23
D6 Security and Compliance	17, 18, 19, 20	25, 26, 27

ON THE EXAM

Two misses in one domain matter more than three spread across six.